

Resources

Learn First Aid

Abdominal Injury
Allergic Reaction/Anaphylaxis
Animal Bites
Asthma Attack
Bleeding - External
Bleeding - Internal
Burns
Cardiac Arrest - Adult
Cardiac Arrest - Child
Cardiac Arrest - Infant
Chest Injury
Choking - Adult/Child
Choking - Infant
Concussion
Dehydration
Diabetic Emergencies
Diarrhea
Eye Injury
Fainting

Fever (Young Child Or Infant)
Fractures
- . .

Fainting

If a person suddenly loses consciousness and then "comes to" after about a minute, he or she may simply have fainted. Fainting is caused by a sudden decrease in blood flow to the brain. Usually the cause of fainting is not serious. For example, being dehydrated (not having enough fluid in the body), being too hot, being in a crowded room or feeling intense emotion can cause a person to faint. After the person faints, the head is at the same level as the heart. This helps blood flow return to the brain and the person quickly recovers.

Find a Class

FIRST AID ▾

 ENTER CITY OR ZIP CODE 

Emergency Steps

1 Check the scene safety, form an initial impression, obtain consent and put on PPE, as appropriate.

2 Check for signs and symptoms.

- Lost of consciousness, then "comes to" in about a minute*
- Pale skin or sweating*
- Weakness or dizziness*
- A sense they will faint; may try to sit
- No warning at all

**Note: Signs and symptoms with a * require immediate emergency medical treatment.*

3 Call 9-1-1 and get equipment, including an AED if available. If the person requires immediate emergency medical treatment.

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 American Red Cross
Training Services

TRAINING + CERTIFICATION:
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RED CROSS STORE ▾

Fever (Young Child Or Infant)
Fractures
Frostbite
Head, Neck, And Spinal Injury
Heart Attack
Heat Exhaustion
Heat Stroke
Hypothermia
Insect Bites And Stings
Jellyfish Stings
Lightning Strike Injury
Mouth Injury
Muscle, Bone And Joint Injury
Nosebleeds
Opioioid Overdose
Pelvic Injury
Poison Exposure
Respiratory Distress
Scorpion Bites
Seizures
Shock
Sickle Cell Crisis/Acute Chest Syndrome
Spider Bites

3 Call 9-1-1 and get equipment, including an AED if available. If the person requires immediate emergency medical treatment.

4 Give Care.

General Care: Fainting

1. Check for responsiveness and breathing.
2. If the person is unresponsive and not breathing (cardiac arrest), immediately begin CPR or compression-only CPR based on level of training and use an AED when available.
3. If the person is breathing but does not respond and there are no injuries, call 9-1-1 if not already done and place them in the recovery position.
4. If the person responds, continue checking them as appropriate to determine if additional care is needed.
5. Keep the person from getting cold or overheated.
6. Give care for shock, if necessary.
7. Position the person in the recovery position.
8. Reassure the person you will help and that EMS has been called (if appropriate).
9. Watch for changes in condition, including breathing and responsiveness, and give care as appropriate and trained.